

Hitesh Manani

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SUMMARY

Azure Cloud Engineer and technical delivery professional with experience across enterprise and public-sector Azure environments, spanning IaaS/PaaS operations, automation, resiliency, security remediation, disaster recovery, and cost optimisation. Operates at the intersection of cloud engineering, product, and customer-facing delivery, translating stakeholder requirements into production-ready Azure platform outcomes, rollout plans, and operational improvements. Built and supported production Azure workloads across multi-subscription customer environments, with hands-on experience in Azure-native automation, patching, monitoring, cost optimisation, and operational workflow design. More recently supported Azure platform delivery and infrastructure optimisation for Q, a sovereign-grade Azure-hosted AI platform used across the ADQ ecosystem, while building and leading the QA/product assurance function, owning release readiness, and contributing to automated provisioning models, production rollouts, and cloud cost reduction initiatives.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Contango (QData), by ADQ

Solutions Delivery Engineer | Manager

Abu Dhabi, UAE

December 2025 - Present

Cross-functional scope across Azure platform delivery, infrastructure optimisation, customer success, product assurance, enterprise implementation, and rollout readiness for Q, a sovereign-grade Azure-hosted AI platform for board governance used across the ADQ ecosystem.

- Built and led the product assurance and QA function for Q, formally managing a 5-person team, serving as final signoff authority for weekly production releases, and owning client-facing release communication for customer rollouts.
- Architected a new Azure proof-of-concept delivery model using shared tenancy and automated provisioning, cutting monthly platform cost from \$15K to \$6K and improving scalability of new customer rollouts.
- Drove Azure cost optimisation and platform architecture changes that reduced spend by a further 10–20% through service redesign, resource optimisation, and capacity tuning.
- Led implementation and adoption for an enterprise POC, driving onboarding, stakeholder workshops, rollout planning, and resolution of customer environment constraints affecting deployment readiness.
- Translated stakeholder requirements into engineering-ready user stories, acceptance criteria, test cases, and Definition of Done for product enhancements and fixes.
- Partnered with product, engineering, and platform leads on feature scoping, roadmap planning, feasibility, release readiness, and prioritisation to move stakeholder requirements into deliverable product improvements.
- Served as technical lead in executive and enterprise demos and solution discussions, presenting Q to senior stakeholders and translating business needs into platform workflows, implementation plans, and adoption strategies.
- Owned backlog execution across Linear and Plane, prioritising bugs, enhancements, blockers, and sprint planning to keep delivery on track

Bespin Global, an e& enterprise company

Cloud Associate (Managed Services)

Abu Dhabi, UAE

November 2022 - November 2025

Cloud engineer across managed Azure environments for enterprise and public-sector customers, spanning IaaS/PaaS operations, automation, resiliency, incident response, security remediation, and service delivery.

- Managed daily operations across multiple enterprise Azure environments, ensuring performance, security, and reliability, and consistency across multi-cloud environments.
- Architected and deployed an event-driven Azure VM patching automation using Event Hub, Logic Apps, Azure Update Manager, Azure Resource Graph, and Managed Identity that auto-started deallocated VMs, creating pre-patch restore points or OS/Data-disk snapshots.
- Added a post-patch reporting pipeline to generate detailed post-patch reports; reduced manual workload by ~1.5–2.0 hrs per patch (~100+ hrs/month at ~50 cycles), and removed dependency on manual ITSM triggers through event-driven execution.
- Engineered failure scopes, idempotency, and concurrency controls to avoid ARM throttling; standardised runbooks across multi-subscription customers.
- Ran recurring DR and backup/restore drills across managed customers, executed planned failover/failback, and published playbooks with post-drill improvements; nominated for Q3 Employee Recognition in Customer Impact for coordinating a customer disaster recovery exercise across technical teams and stakeholders.
- Developed automation scripts in PowerShell and Python for Azure and M365, saving ~20 staff hours/week.
- Acted as escalation point for high-priority incidents; triaged critical alerts, coordinated resolution (Jira/Trello), and drove RCA to meet SLAs and prevent recurrences.
- Authored SOPs/runbooks for patching, DR, backup/restore, and incident response; improved 24/7 shift handoffs and MTTR.
- Fine-tuned alerts in New Relic/Datadog, cutting alert fatigue by ~38% and speeding escalations; conducted security remediation exercises to raise secure scores by 10–15% on average.
- Analysed spend with Azure Cost Management; recommended budgeting, Reservations/Savings Plans and workload optimisations to reduce client operational costs.

Bespin Global, an e& enterprise company*Cloud Engineer/DevOps Intern***Abu Dhabi, UAE***September 2022 - November 2022*

- Built HA Azure environments aligned to the Well-Architected Framework; implemented initial CI/CD with Azure DevOps, reducing deployment time by ~40%.

EDUCATION

Heriot-Watt University*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (First Class Honours) (GPA: 4.0)**Awards: 3 x Deputy Principal's Award Recipient***CERTIFICATIONS**

Microsoft - Azure Administrator (AZ-104)**Microsoft - Azure Network Engineer (AZ-700)****Microsoft - Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900)****Microsoft - Azure AI Engineer (AI-102)****Microsoft AI Product Manager Professional****IPMA: Project Management Fundamentals****Microsoft Partner Sales Acceleration Bootcamp****Microsoft Sales: Threat Protection - Proficient****PROJECTS**

Azure Cloud Resume*Live Website: <https://www.hiteshmanani.me/>*

- Hosted a static resume site on Azure Storage fronted by Azure CDN with a custom domain (DNS) and TLS.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions for both frontend and backend components.
- Built a serverless API with Azure Functions (Node.js) backed by Azure Cosmos DB to track site visit count.
- Added a JavaScript counter integrated with the API/DB for real-time updates.

SKILLS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (IaaS/PaaS), Azure Functions, Logic Apps, Azure Update Manager, Azure Resource Graph, Managed Identity, Application Gateway, WAF, BCDR, Azure Cost Management, Solution Delivery**Automation & Delivery:** Terraform, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, CI/CD, PowerShell, Python, Deployment Automation, Release Management, Environment Management, Event-Driven Workflows**Monitoring & Operations:** Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, KQL, Datadog, New Relic, Incident Response, RCA, Runbooks, Production Support**Product & Customer Delivery:** Roadmap Planning, Release Planning, Feature Feasibility Assessment, PRDs, A/B Testing, Requirements Gathering, Customer Feedback Synthesis, Cross-Functional Delivery, Technical Demos, Onboarding Enablement, Stakeholder Management**AI & Platform Tools:** Azure AI Foundry, LLM Evaluation, AI Feature Validation, Phoenix, GitHub, Postman, SharePoint, Linear, Notion, Miro**INVOLVEMENT**

Microsoft Reactor MEA, AWS User Group Abu Dhabi, Volunteers.ae, ProductTank Abu Dhabi, Consultants for Impact